

Everyday Events By W. J. HOOTEN

It's always nice to have a former member of The Times staff, who has settled happily elsewhere, drop in for a chat.

Buck Lanier, former regional editor of The Times, now with the Long Beach Independent Press Telegram, paid me a visit and I enjoyed listening to his experiences in Vietnam, where he has been four times.

Buck approves of President Nixon's policy of gradual withdrawal of American forces and Vietnamization of the war. He says we already are involved in Laos, but that he hopes no ground forces are sent in.

"Laos isn't worth the life of a single American soldier," he said.

Buck said 22 American newsmen have been killed in Vietnam and 50 wounded.

MORE HISTORY

After the Revolutionary War, the 13 original colonies were each recognized as an independent and sovereign state in the treaty signed at Versailles by England in 1783.

That was the information given me Tuesday by Dr. Eugene O. Porter in commenting on the discussion concerning states that were republics before admission to the Union.

In an editorial Monday morning I wrote that Texas was the only state to have been an independent republic before it was admitted to the Union.

Some readers have disagreed. California had a Bear Republic for a while, I was told, and Vermont had been a republic when it was admitted as the 14th state, I also was informed.

BUYING ALUMINUM CANS

Andy Cohen, whom I have known since he left El Paso to play baseball with the New York Giants in the 1920s, dropped by to tell me about how Coors is buying aluminum cans in cooperation with the anti-litter campaign.

He left some statistics on the problem of waste, which follow in part:

"Sometimes statistics are too much for the weary mind to comprehend. If we substitute comparisons, it is much easier for us to get the significance.

"When we say the United States of America is desperately trying to find a place to put three and one half billion tons of solid waste each year, isn't it hard to realize just how much that is?

"If it is, then maybe some of these comparisons will help . . .

"If we add 6 million discarded automobiles to the 3½ billion tons of solid waste, we could fill the Panama Canal four times a year.

"America's rubbish each year now contains 26 billion bottles and jars, 48 billion cans and 65 billion metal or plastic caps to crown these bottles and cans.

"Just the city of New York could fill the Empire State Building 15 times each year with solid packed rubbish; or picture it this way — on a base the size of Yankee Stadium, New York's rubbish for 12 months would make a mountain one mile high.

"There are 36 billion tons of paper used in the United States each year.

"Did you know that New York City now has 50,000 automobiles abandoned on its streets each year?"